

Brief report on Joint Monitoring field visit



Lakhanpur-7, Dorumba Rural Municipality Ward no-7
21st – 23rd March 2018

Background:

Ramechhap, one of the districts of province number 3 is one of the 14 most earthquake affected districts which comprises of 6 Rural Municipalities and 3 Municipalities. The district has various climates from upper tropical to Nival. It is the second dry district of Nepal the one after Mustang. About 42% of land coverage lies under sub-tropical climate. Amongst the 14 district, Ramechhap is one of the most affected district from 25 April, 2015 Earthquake. Through the destruction by earthquake in Ramechhap is as below:

- Number of Death =39
- Number of Injured People =64
- Number of Damaged Houses = 45,050
- Number of Partially Damaged Houses=2149
- Number Damaged Schools = 419
- Number of Damaged Health center=52

Housing Recovery and Reconstruction Platform (HRRP) is working in Nepal to support government authorities(NRA, MOUD/DUDBC, MOFALD) in coordination, Strategic planning, facilitating cooperation with the national and international organizations, the private sector, overseas labour migrants (remittances), and public associations involve in recovery and reconstruction under the guidance of GON. In this regards team Ramechhap has conducted and successfully completed the joint field monitoring visit to Lakhanpur-7, Dorumba Rural Municipality of Ramechhap District on 21st to 23rd of March 2018.

Objective of Field Visit:

The main objectives of the field visit were as follows:

- To observe the reconstruction status of the beneficiaries
- To provide inputs to the beneficiaries in regards of housing reconstruction and for grant receive process
- Interaction with the local representatives and beneficiaries to find the challenges and issues in the reconstruction.

Team Involved in the Joint Field Monitoring visit:

- Er. Roshan Kumar Yadav- National Reconstruction Authority (NRA)
- Prakash Bishwakarma , District General Coordinator-HRRP
- Jawed Mohammad, Information management-HRRP

Site details:

Lakhanpur ward-7 is one of the rural village of Dorumba Rural Municipality, Ramechhap. It lies in the west of district headquarter. The area was severely damage during the earthquake 2015. The most of the houses were of traditional type design mostly of stone and cement mortar.

Field Observation:

In Lakhanpur (Thapa Gaun) almost all beneficiaries who have signed PA agreement have started the reconstruction. The houses under construction are mostly of stone in mud and cement mortar as stone is locally available. The availability of other construction materials such as bricks, cement and iron is difficult due to high cost of transportation. Engineer and sub Engineer have been deployed in the area by DLPIU-Ramechhap, with the effort from the technical person, the reconstruction rate of the area is being improved. The government technical staffs have been conducting community orientation and door to door technical assistant on regular basis. The reconstruction in the area is fully supported by the local representative and community.

Reconstruction update of the area (As of 21st March 2018)

- Total number of beneficiaries : 405
- PA agreement signed : 405
- 1st Tranche : 405
- 2nd Tranche: 150
- 3rd Tranche : 25
- Grievance registered : 113
- Grievance addressed : 53
- Non Compliance Case: 11

Source: update from Chairperson of Ward-7, Dorumba Rural Municipality

Some Highlights discussion with the ward members at Lakhanpur-7, Dorumba Rural Municipality

- About 95% of the beneficiaries have started reconstruction and about 50% of people get 2nd tranche of government reconstruction grant.
- The houses are built using local material such as stone with earthquake resistant elements.
- The technical people deployed from the DLPIU have been actively working in the area and have visited the houses of the beneficiaries to provide technical assistance in the community.
- The ward office has been supporting technical staffs in disseminating the information on the safer reconstruction and government grant procedure as well as guideline.
- Ward Chairperson and meeting participants were shared their problem and challenges regarding reconstruction. i.e lack of skilled labor.
- A total of 11 Noncompliance cases were registered in the area.
- Beneficiaries have positive attitude towards the government support and have been following the government guideline during the reconstruction.
- A total of 12 vulnerable household were registered in the area and further process as carryout for further.
- Recently 4 members from the community have been involved in the mason training organized at rural municipality office.

During the field visit and meeting with the ward-7 member the reconstruction status of ward-5 have been updated from the telephone from the respective members of ward 5. The reconstruction rate is as below:

Area	Ward	Total Beneficiary	PA Agreement	1 st Tranche	2 nd Tranche	3 rd Tranche
Gausara	5	692	692	692	152	47

Partner organization involvement:

Apart from the government support few Non-government organization are working in the area, that is Community Development Society and Sunalo Hajar USAID funded project. These organization are working in the field of sanitation, health. Similarly, PAF and small cottage and industry have provided training on Manson. A total of 6 members from the community has been awarded from the training. All the trained mason are actively involved in the reconstruction. Regarding to this no any other organization are working in the reconstruction.

Key Issues, Challenges and suggested Way Forward

SN	Issues/Challenges	Way Forward ...
1	Scarcity of Water Supply: Ramechhap has been listed in the second driest district of Nepal. Water Supply has been a major problem in the district. All the reconstruction activities have not been able to gain a pace.	All the partner organizations working under Wash Sector must co-ordinate with NRA and conduct the activities in those areas where the water supply problem is severe. Also POs can provide assistance in water supply also.
2	Scarcity of materials: The availability of the materials for reconstruction have not been efficiently provided in the district. The district has been facing the problem of prohibition of heavy vehicles so that the transportation cost has been high and have not been able to import sufficient materials. Also there is no sufficient wood in the district.	- The DFO Should go through necessary process for importing wood from neighbouring districts (which has just been initiated must rapid up) - The necessary arrangement for entry of heavy vehicle or subsidy must be given for the transportation.
3	Shortage of Skilled Construction Workers: About 4000-5000 people are provided mason training in the district to handle the overall reconstruction in the district but migration of trained people make it not sufficient.	- Skilled Mason Trainings and OJTs need to be carried out. - GON shall carryout program to stop youth migrating. - Supply of skilled masons from other areas or out of district may be another option.
4	Lengthy process for withdraw the government reconstruction grant tranche money to the beneficiaries	District Treasury Controller office shall pre-notice about the list to the respective rural municipality ward for the easy transition of government reconstruction tranche to the beneficiaries.
5	12 households were identified as a vulnerable community in ward no-7.	- Respective ward and Rural Municipality should do further process to as guided by government. - Coordination with district NRA and District coordination committee for further process.

Experience Sharing of Beneficiaries:

1. Trained mason couple

Amar Yongan and Sunmaya Tamang is trained mason from Lakhanpur, Ward no-7, Dorumba Rural Municipality, Ramechhap. Mr. Amar Younjan and Mrs. Tamang received 7 days mason training conducted by Poverty alleviation Fund (PAF) in February 2018 at Takarpur along with other mason. Their house were damaged by the 2015 earthquake and they received 1st tranche as an effected beneficiaries. They shared their story and explained that the support of poverty Alleviation fund project has provided mason training. Being illiterate it as difficult to understand the content of training for wife but due to the help from her husband and support from the trainer she completed the training course. It was very difficult to start reconstruction of their house due to the skilled labor in the village because youth are migration to aboard for employment. Considering the fact they proudly stated that the training has helped them to reconstruction their damaged house. Now they have completed their house up to roof with stone cement mortar. Through the training and involved in the reconstruction work make more confident and hard working. Currently Amar and his wife Sunmaya constructing their house and support to other untrained mason during the reconstruction process.



photo 1 Amar and Sunmaya : Trained Couple mason from Lakhanpur, Ramechhap

2. Reconstruction Completed:

Naryan Bahadur Nagarkoti one of beneficiary from Lakhanpur, ward no -7 Thapa Gaun , Dorumba Rural Municipality, Ramechhap. Mr. Nagarkoti house was completely damaged during the 2015 earthquake. With the first tranche received from the government, he started the reconstruction of the house. Mr. Narayan Bahadur Nagarkoti house is constructed using stone and cement mortar and CGI roof. The house is completed and Mr. Nagarkoti has received all three tranche of the government housing reconstruction grant. He is happy living in the new house and is confident that the next earthquake will not destroyed his new house constructed under the technical supervision.



Photo 2 Narayan Bahadur Ngarkoti is setting in front of his newly constructed house in Lakhanpur, Ramechhap



Meeting with Ward members at Lakhanpur ward no-7, Dorumba Rural Municipality on 22nd March 2018



Caption: The house of Mr. Amar Younjan resident of ward number 7, Dorumba Rural Municipality being constructed using stone in cement mortar. The RC Bands have been provided to the house. The owner has received the second tranche and expected to be completed by the end of Baisak.



Caption: The Four roomed house of Padam Bahadur Magar, resident of ward -3, Sunapati Rural Municipality. The house is constructed using bricks cement mortar



Caption: Photo with ward chairperson and ward members after the ward level meeting at Dorumba Rural Municipality ward-7.

Annex 1. Photos